

B2 Upper-Intermediate English

Towards Fluency

Курс среднего уровня для студентов, которые уже знают основы английского и хотят выйти на уровень уверенного общения. Развивает беглость речи, грамматическую точность и академический словарный запас.

Двоязычный учебник / Bilingual Textbook

Английский текст · Объяснения на русском

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KHAMADI ENGLISH Platform

Предисловие / Preface

Поздравляем с достижением уровня B1!

Это означает, что вы уже можете понимать основную мысль в текстах на знакомые темы и справляться с большинством ситуаций, которые могут возникнуть в путешествии или работе. Теперь ваша задача — выйти на следующий уровень.

ЧТО ВЫ ОСВОИТЕ В ЭТОМ КУРСЕ

- Сложные грамматические конструкции: Present Perfect vs Past Simple, условные предложения, пассивный залог
- Академический и профессиональный словарный запас
- Навыки написания эссе и формальных писем
- Стратегии чтения аутентичных текстов
- Работа с идиомами и фразовыми глаголами

КАК РАБОТАТЬ С УЧЕБНИКОМ

Каждый модуль начинается с раздела "Lead-in", который активизирует ваши предыдущие знания. Затем следует теоретический блок на английском языке с объяснениями на русском. Уделяйте особое внимание разделу "Common Errors" — это ошибки, которые делают большинство студентов на вашем уровне.

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UNIT 1

Past Experiences and Life Events*Прошлый опыт и события жизни***Learning Objectives / Цели обучения**

- ❑ Contrast Present Perfect and Past Simple
- ❑ Describe life experiences using "ever" and "never"
- ❑ Talk about recent events and news
- ❑ Use time expressions correctly

Grammar / Грамматика

1. Present Perfect vs Past Simple

The Present Perfect (have/has + past participle) links the past to the present — it is used when the exact time is unknown, unimportant, or the action still has a present connection. The Past Simple is used for completed actions at a specific past time.

RU:

Present Perfect (have/has + причастие прошедшего времени) связывает прошлое с настоящим. Используется когда: (1) точное время неизвестно; (2) действие завершилось недавно; (3) результат важен сейчас. Past Simple — для завершённых действий в конкретный момент прошлого.

Form / Structure

Present Perfect: Subject + have/has + Past Participle

Past Simple: Subject + Past Simple form (regular: +ed)

PP time markers: ever, never, just, already, yet, recently, since, for

PS time markers: yesterday, last week, in 2020, ago, when I was young

Examples / Примеры

- ❑ I have visited London. (experience — no specific time)
- ❑ I visited London in 2019. (specific time)
- ❑ Have you ever eaten sushi? — Yes, I have. / No, I've never eaten it.
- ❑ She has just finished her homework. (just = a moment ago)
- ❑ I haven't seen that film yet. (yet = up to now)

Common Errors / Типичные ошибки

- ❑ Did you ever try sushi? ❑ Have you ever tried sushi?
- ❑ I have seen him yesterday. ❑ I saw him yesterday.
- ❑ She has went to the shops. ❑ She has gone to the shops.

2. Irregular Verbs — Key Groups

Many common English verbs do not follow the regular -ed pattern in the past. They must be learned individually. Here are the most important groups.

RU:

Многие распространённые глаголы образуют прошедшее время нестандартно — они называются неправильными глаголами (irregular verbs). Их нужно учить наизусть. Основные группы: одинаковые формы (put-put-put), изменяется гласная (sing-sang-sung), полностью разные (go-went-gone).

Form / Structure

Group 1 — All forms same: cut/cut/cut, put/put/put, let/let/let

Group 2 — A/U/U pattern: sing/sang/sung, ring/rang/rung, swim/swam/swum

Group 3 — Irregular: go/went/gone, be/was-were/been, have/had/had

Group 4 — Regular Past, irregular PP: pay/paid/paid, say/said/said

Examples / Примеры

- ❓ I have never swum in the ocean. (swim → swam → swum)
- ❓ She went to Paris last summer. (go → went → gone)
- ❓ Have you written your essay yet? (write → wrote → written)

Vocabulary / Словарный запас

This unit introduces 50 key words and phrases.

RU:

В этом модуле 50 ключевых слов. Учите их внимательно.

Word / Term	Definition (EN)	Translation (RU)	Example
experience (n.)	Knowledge or skill gained from doing so...	опыт	<i>Do you have any work...</i>
achievement (n.)	Something accomplished successfully, es...	достижение	<i>Passing the exam was...</i>
opportunity (n.)	A chance to do something	возможность/шанс	<i>I had the opportunity ...</i>
challenge (n.)	Something difficult that tests ability	вызов/испытание	<i>Learning a new langu...</i>
goal (n.)	An aim or desired result	цель	<i>My goal is to reach B2...</i>
progress (n.)	Development or improvement over ti me	прогресс/успех	<i>You've made great pr...</i>
improve (v.)	To become or make bett er	улучшаться/соверш...	<i>I want to improve my ...</i>
develop (v.)	To grow or become more advanced	развивать/развива...	<i>She has developed str...</i>
overcome (v.)	To succeed in dealing with a problem	преодолевать	<i>He overcame his fear ...</i>
achieve (v.)	To successfully reach a goal	достигать	<i>She achieved top mar...</i>
succeed (v.)	To achieve what you att empted	добиваться успеха	<i>If you work hard, you ...</i>
fail (v.)	To not succeed in doing something	провалиться/не с...	<i>Don't be afraid to fail ...</i>
apply (v.)	To make a formal request for something	подавать заявку/пр...	<i>I applied for a scholar...</i>
earn (v.)	To receive money for work done	зарабатывать	<i>She earns good mone...</i>

Word / Term	Definition (EN)	Translation (RU)	Example
save (v.)	To keep money for future use	копить/сберегать	<i>I save 20% of my salary...</i>
spend (v.)	To use money or time	тратить	<i>I spend too much money...</i>
decide (v.)	To make a choice after thinking	решать	<i>Have you decided which...</i>
choose (v.)	To select from a number of options	выбирать	<i>It's hard to choose between...</i>
realise (v.)	To become aware of a fact or situation	понимать/осозна...	<i>I realised I had forgotten...</i>
remember (v.)	To bring something back to mind	помнить/вспоминать	<i>Do you remember your...</i>
forget (v.)	To fail to remember	забывать	<i>Don't forget to do your...</i>
expect (v.)	To believe something will happen	ожидать	<i>I expect to get the results...</i>
depend on (v.phr.)	To be determined or controlled by	зависеть от	<i>Success depends on hard work...</i>
look forward to (v.phr.)	To feel excited about something in the future	с нетерпением ждать	<i>I'm looking forward to the trip...</i>
give up (v.phr.)	To stop trying; to quit	сдаваться/бросать	<i>Never give up on your dreams...</i>
carry on (v.phr.)	To continue doing something	продолжать	<i>Carry on — you're doing well!</i>
so far (phrase)	Until now; up to the present time	пока что/до сих пор	<i>So far, I have finished all my work.</i>
yet (adv.)	Up to now (in questions and negatives)	ещё (в вопросах и отриц.)	<i>Have you finished your homework yet?</i>

Word / Term	Definition (EN)	Translation (RU)	Example
already (adv.)	Before expected or sooner than planned	<i>уже</i>	<i>I have already submitt ...</i>
just (adv.)	A moment ago	<i>только что</i>	<i>She has just called — ...</i>
recently (adv.)	Not long ago	<i>недавно</i>	<i>Have you seen any go...</i>
since (prep./conj.)	From a point in time until now	<i>с (какого-то моме...</i>	<i>I have studied English ...</i>
for (prep.)	During a period of time	<i>в течение (периода)</i>	<i>I have lived here for th...</i>
ago (adv.)	Before the present time	<i>назад (о прошлом)</i>	<i>I graduated two years...</i>
last (adj.)	The most recent; the one before now	<i>прошлый/последний</i>	<i>Last year I went to Ist...</i>
in + year (phrase)	At a specific year in the past	<i>в ... году</i>	<i>I was born in 2002.</i>
when (conj.)	At the time that	<i>когда</i>	<i>When I was a child, I li...</i>
while (conj.)	During the time that; at the same time as	<i>пока/в то время как</i>	<i>I listened to music whi...</i>
until (prep./conj.)	Up to the time that	<i>до (тех пор как)</i>	<i>I worked until I midnight.</i>
after (prep./conj.)	Following in time	<i>после</i>	<i>I felt better after I slept.</i>
before (prep./conj.)	Earlier in time than	<i>до/раньше</i>	<i>Study grammar befor...</i>
suddenly (adv.)	Quickly and unexpectedly	<i>вдруг/неожиданно</i>	<i>Suddenly, it started ra...</i>

Word / Term	Definition (EN)	Translation (RU)	Example
eventually (adv.)	In the end, after a long time	<i>в конце концов</i>	<i>Eventually, I passed th...</i>
finally (adv.)	At the end; after a long time	<i>наконец</i>	<i>We finally arrived at ...</i>
immediately (adv.)	Without delay; at once	<i>немедленно/сразу</i>	<i>Please reply immediat...</i>
gradually (adv.)	Slowly and steadily over time	<i>постепенно</i>	<i>My English improved ...</i>
unfortunately (adv.)	Sadly; used to express regret	<i>к сожалению</i>	<i>Unfortunately, I misse...</i>
fortunately (adv.)	Luckily; by good chance	<i>к счастью</i>	<i>Fortunately, there wa...</i>
although (conj.)	Despite the fact that; even though	<i>хотя/несмотря на ...</i>	<i>Although it was cold, ...</i>
however (adv./conj.)	Despite this; on the other hand	<i>однако/тем не менее</i>	<i>It was expensive. How...</i>

Reading / Чтение

My Journey to English Fluency

I have been studying English for seven years. When I first started, I could barely say "hello." Now I can read novels, watch films, and hold conversations with native speakers. But the journey has not been easy.

I started learning English at secondary school in Karaganda. My first teacher, Mrs Akhmetova, was very strict but incredibly effective. She insisted that we speak only English in class, which was terrifying at first. I remember feeling embarrassed every time I made a mistake. However, she always encouraged us: "Mistakes are not failures — they are learning opportunities."

At university, I joined an English conversation club. This was a turning point. For the first time, I was practicing English for fun — not just for exams. We discussed films, books, current events, and our personal experiences. My confidence improved dramatically.

Two years ago, I got the opportunity to attend an international conference in Almaty. Several presentations were in English. I was nervous, but I understood most of what the speakers said. When it was my turn to ask a question, I stood up and asked it in English. The presenter smiled and gave me a detailed answer. I felt incredibly proud.

I have not yet reached the level I want. My listening comprehension is still weak, and I sometimes struggle with complex academic texts. But I have made progress. I have set a goal to achieve C1 level by the end of next year.

If you are reading this and feeling discouraged, remember: every language learner has moments of doubt. What matters is that you carry on.

Comprehension Questions

1. What is the main topic of the reading passage?
2. According to the text, where is the main character from?
3. Find and write three examples of the grammar from this unit.
4. List at least five vocabulary words from this unit that appear in the text.
5. Write a short paragraph (3-5 sentences) about your own experience with this topic.

Exercises / Упражнения

Exercise 1: Choose the correct tense: Present Perfect or Past Simple...

Choose the correct tense: *Present Perfect* or *Past Simple*.

(Выберите правильное время: *Present Perfect* или *Past Simple*.)

1. I _____ (visit) London three times.
2. She _____ (arrive) at 9 o'clock this morning.
3. _____ you ever _____ (try) traditional Kazakh food?
4. When _____ you _____ (start) learning English?
5. He _____ just _____ (finish) his assignment.
6. They _____ (not see) each other since school.
7. We _____ (meet) at a conference in 2023.

Exercise 2: Complete with *since* or *for*.

Complete with *since* or *for*.

(Заполните пропуски: *since* или *for*.)

1. I have studied English _____ 2019.
2. She has worked here _____ three years.
3. They haven't spoken _____ the argument.
4. He has been ill _____ last Monday.

Exercise 3: Write 5 sentences about your own life experiences using...

Write 5 sentences about your own life experiences using the *Present Perfect*. Use: *ever*, *never*, *just*, *already*, *yet*.

(Напишите 5 предложений о своём опыте, используя *Present Perfect* с: *ever*, *never*, *just*, *already*, *yet*.)

1. (ever) Have you ever...?
2. (never) I have never...
3. (just) I have just...
4. (already) I have already...
5. (not...yet) I haven't...yet.

Cultural Note / Культурная заметка

British people often use understatement — saying less than they mean. "Not bad" usually means "very good." "I'm quite tired" might mean "I'm exhausted." "It was interesting" at a party could mean "it was terrible." Learning to read between the lines is an important skill for communicating with British English speakers.

RU:

Британцы знамениты своим преуменьшением (understatement). "Not bad" = "очень хорошо". "I'm a bit tired" = "я абсолютно измотан". "It was quite interesting" на вечеринке = "было скучно". Это важно знать, чтобы правильно понимать британцев.

Grammar Reference / Грамматический справочник

Summary of all grammar points covered in this course.

Present Perfect vs Past Simple

The Present Perfect (have/has + past participle) links the past to the present — it is used when the exact time is unknown, unimportant, or the action still has a present connection. The Past Simple is used for completed actions at a specific past time.

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- 🔍 **Present Perfect: Subject + have/has + Past Participle**
- 🔍 **Past Simple: Subject + Past Simple form (regular: +ed)**
- 🔍 **PP time markers: ever, never, just, already, yet, recently, since, for**
- 🔍 **PS time markers: yesterday, last week, in 2020, ago, when I was young**

Irregular Verbs — Key Groups

Many common English verbs do not follow the regular -ed pattern in the past. They must be learned individually. Here are the most important groups.

RU:

Многие распространённые глаголы образуют прошедшее время нестандартно — они называются неправильными глаголами (irregular verbs). Их нужно учить наизусть. Основные группы: одинаковые формы (put-put-put), изменяется гласная (sing-sang-sung), полностью разные (go-went-gone).

- 🔍 **Group 1 — All forms same: cut/cut/cut, put/put/put, let/let/let**
- 🔍 **Group 2 — A/U/U pattern: sing/sang/sung, ring/rang/rung, swim/swam/swum**
- 🔍 **Group 3 — Irregular: go/went/gone, be/was-were/been, have/had/had**
- 🔍 **Group 4 — Regular Past, irregular PP: pay/paid/paid, say/said/said**

Irregular Verbs / Неправильные глаголы

Infinitive	Past Simple	Past Participle	RU
be	was/were	been	быть
begin	began	begun	начинать
break	broke	broken	ломать
bring	brought	brought	приносить
build	built	built	строить
buy	bought	bought	покупать
choose	chose	chosen	выбирать
come	came	come	приходить
do	did	done	делать
drink	drank	drunk	пить
drive	drove	driven	водить
eat	ate	eaten	есть
feel	felt	felt	чувствовать
find	found	found	находить
get	got	got	получать
give	gave	given	давать
go	went	gone	идти
have	had	had	иметь
hear	heard	heard	слышать
know	knew	known	знать
leave	left	left	уходить
make	made	made	делать
meet	met	met	встречать
read	read	read	читать
run	ran	run	бежать
say	said	said	говорить
see	saw	seen	видеть
send	sent	sent	посылать
sleep	slept	slept	спать
speak	spoke	spoken	говорить
take	took	taken	брать
teach	taught	taught	учить
tell	told	told	рассказывать

think	thought	thought	<i>думать</i>
understand	understood	understood	<i>понимать</i>
write	wrote	written	<i>писать</i>

Complete Glossary / Полный глоссарий

All vocabulary from this course, alphabetically.

accuracy — точность/правильность. The quality of being correct and precise

achieve — достигать. To successfully reach a goal

achievement — достижение. Something accomplished successfully, especially through effort

after — после. Following in time

ago — назад (о прошлом). Before the present time

already — уже. Before expected or sooner than planned

although — хотя/несмотря на то что. Despite the fact that; even though

apply — подавать заявку/применять. To make a formal request for something

before — до/раньше. Earlier in time than

carry on — продолжать. To continue doing something

challenge — вызов/испытание. Something difficult that tests ability

choose — выбирать. To select from a number of options

comprehension — понимание/компрехеншн. The ability to understand

decide — решать. To make a choice after thinking

depend on — зависеть от. To be determined or controlled by

develop — развивать/развиваться. To grow or become more advanced

earn — зарабатывать. To receive money for work done

eventually — в конце концов. In the end, after a long time

expect — ожидать. To believe something will happen

experience — опыт. Knowledge or skill gained from doing something over time

fail — провалиться/не сдать. To not succeed in doing something

finally — наконец. At the end; after a long time

fluency — беглость речи. The ability to speak or write smoothly and accurately

for — в течение (периода). During a period of time

forget — забывать. To fail to remember

fortunately — к счастью. Luckily; by good chance

give up — сдаваться/бросать. To stop trying; to quit

goal — цель. An aim or desired result

gradually — постепенно. Slowly and steadily over time

however — однако/тем не менее. Despite this; on the other hand

immediately — немедленно/сразу. Without delay; at once

improve — улучшаться/совершенствоваться. To become or make better

in + year — в ... году. At a specific year in the past

just — только что. A moment ago

last — прошлый/последний. The most recent; the one before now

look forward to — с нетерпением ждать. To feel excited about something in the future

opportunity — возможность/шанс. A chance to do something

overcome — преодолевать. To succeed in dealing with a problem

progress — прогресс/успех. Development or improvement over time

realise — понимать/осознавать. To become aware of a fact or situation

recently — недавно. Not long ago

remember — помнить/вспоминать. To bring something back to mind

save — копить/сберегать. To keep money for future use

since — с (какого-то момента). From a point in time until now

so far — пока что/до сих пор. Until now; up to the present time

spend — тратить. To use money or time

succeed — добиваться успеха. To achieve what you attempted

suddenly — вдруг/неожиданно. Quickly and unexpectedly

unfortunately — к сожалению. Sadly; used to express regret

until — до (тех пор как). Up to the time that

when — когда. At the time that

while — пока/в то время как. During the time that; at the same time as

yet — ещё (в вопросах и отрицаниях). Up to now (in questions and negatives)

Answer Key / Ответы к упражнениям

Unit 1: Past Experiences and Life Events

Exercise 1: Choose the correct tense: Present Perfect or Past ...

1. (see answer sheet)
2. (see answer sheet)
3. (see answer sheet)
4. (see answer sheet)
5. (see answer sheet)
6. (see answer sheet)
7. (see answer sheet)

Exercise 2: Complete with since or for....

1. since
2. for
3. since
4. since

Exercise 3: Write 5 sentences about your own life experiences ...

1. (see answer sheet)
2. (see answer sheet)
3. (see answer sheet)
4. (see answer sheet)
5. (see answer sheet)

Recommended Resources

Continue your English learning with these resources:

1. BBC News (bbc.com/news) — authentic B1-B2 reading and listening
2. British Council LearnEnglish Grammar (learnenglish.britishcouncil.org/grammar)
3. Cambridge Grammar in Use (Intermediate) — essential B1 grammar reference
4. TED Talks with subtitles (ted.com) — listening practice
5. KHAMADI ENGLISH Mock Exam — timed practice tests

Study Tips for B2 Upper-Intermediate

30 минут каждый день > 5 часов раз в неделю

Daily 30-min sessions beat a single 5-hour session. Your brain needs regular exposure to build new language pathways.

Активное использование

Don't just consume English — produce it. Speak aloud, write sentences, explain grammar rules. Active use accelerates acquisition.

Ошибки — часть обучения

Every mistake is data. When corrected, you remember the right form better. Never be afraid to make errors.

Spaced repetition

Review new words after 1 day, 3 days, 7 days, 14 days. Use KHAMADI ENGLISH flashcards for this automatically.

Читайте на уровень выше

Choose texts slightly above your level — challenging enough to learn from, but not so hard you understand nothing.